Questioning False Beliefs

By Brian Campbell, Ph.D. · © 2013

Instructions

The challenging questions listed below can be used to attack faulty beliefs, negative thoughts, or negative "self-talk." In the space below, list an irrational belief or lie that you have accepted as being true (for example: This is hopeless; I'm stupid; I'll never get over this; This is the worst thing that could possibly happen).

My false belief:

_____

_____

Next, go through the list of questions below and put a check mark next to any question that "speaks to" or "calls into question" the validity of your faulty belief. Then go back and underline those questions. Finally, copy the irrational belief and the questions you identified onto a 3-by-5 card, and keep the card with you in your pocket or purse. Read the card regularly each day for the next week.

Spiritual Questions

- ☐ How might Christ view this problem or situation?
- ☐ How does the Bible speak to this?
- ☐ What would Christ do in this situation?
- ☐ How does my problem compare to being nailed to a cross?
- ☐ How might an all-loving God look at me or this situation?
- ☐ How does my problem compare to my eternal salvation?
- ☐ Can my negative thoughts defeat the Creator of the universe?
- ☐ Does my thinking reflect God's will or my will?
- ☐ Is my problem really too big for God?
- ☐ Do I need to "let go and let God" work in my life?
- ☐ Am I putting God first in my life?
- ☐ Do I have my priorities right?
- ☐ Has God given up hope that things will get better for me?
- ☐ Are my thoughts consistent with God's plan for my life?
- ☐ Have I prayed about this situation?
- ☐ If I die tonight, how much will this matter?
- ☐ What will material things matter on Judgment Day?
- ☐ If I told Jesus my belief, would He agree with me?
- ☐ Have I overlooked some of the gifts that God has given me?
- ☐ Won't God forgive me if I just ask?
- ☐ Are my sins really too big for the God of the universe to forgive?

- ☐ Is anyone perfect? Haven't we all sinned and fallen short of the glory of God?
- ☐ Hasn't God given me free will and the ability to change?
- ☐ Does God still love me despite my faults or limitations?

General Questions

- ☐ Are there other ways of looking at this situation?
- ☐ Am I exaggerating the significance of what happened?
- ☐ How long do I plan to keep holding on to this false belief?
- ☐ Am I keeping things in perspective?
- ☐ Am I blowing things up way out of proportion?
- ☐ How does this problem compare to having cancer?
- ☐ Is it possible that I've been believing a lie my entire life?
- ☐ How will I feel about this problem or event ten years from now?
- ☐ What's the actual evidence for my belief?
- ☐ Just because my parents or others told me this, does that make it true?
- ☐ Is it possible that my parents or others taught me unhealthy thinking?
- ☐ Is it possible that I am distorting the facts?
- ☐ What's the worst thing that could possibly happen, and "So what?"
- ☐ Will I shrivel up and die if this happens?
- ☐ Are there things that I can learn from my mistakes?
- ☐ Do I really have to be perfect? Is any human being perfect?
- ☐ What are some of the best arguments against my belief or conclusion?
- ☐ What are the odds that the thing I dread will actually happen?
- ☐ Can I really predict the future?
- ☐ How often do the things I worry about actually occur?
- ☐ If I were a betting person, would I bet a million dollars that the thing I dread will happen?
- ☐ Is it possible to change the past?
- ☐ Am I underestimating my ability to cope?
- ☐ Have I dealt with problems like this in the past?
- ☐ Am I being too hard on myself?
- ☐ Am I really the cause of the problem, or did someone just try to convince me that I am?
- ☐ Am I exaggerating my faults or limitations?
- ☐ Doesn't everyone have good points and bad points?
- ☐ How much do I really need to live on?
- ☐ Even if my thoughts are true, do I want to live the rest of my life this way?
- ☐ Is this really the most important thing in life?
- ☐ Does everyone have to like me in order for me to be happy?
- ☐ Do I really need a parent's love to survive?
- ☐ How have other people handled situations like mine?
- ☐ How might a good friend view this situation?
- ☐ How long do I plan to stay depressed or anxious?
- ☐ What are some ways that I could make my situation worse?
- ☐ What are some positive things I could learn from this?
- ☐ What are some of the blessings God has given me?
- ☐ Am I completely destined to stay this way my whole life?
- ☐ Am I absolutely certain that nothing can be done about this problem or situation?

"We tear down arguments and every presumption set up against the knowledge of God; and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ." (2 Corinthians 10:5)